Answers and talk notes

Divide Whole Numbers by Fractions

What your student is learning

Tonight we divide a whole number by a fraction in a real counting problem — how many small bags a big amount fills.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **C.** bigger than the whole number. Small pieces fit more times, so the answer is bigger than the whole number.
2. **A.** 6 ÷ 2/3. The whole amount (6 pounds) is split into bags of 2/3 pound, so 6 ÷ 2/3.
3. **B.** 12. Flip 3/4 to 4/3: 9 × 4/3 = 36/3 = 12.
4. **D.** 12. Flip 5/6 to 6/5: 10 × 6/5 = 60/5 = 12.
5. **A.** 8. 6 ÷ 3/4 = 6 × 4/3 = 24/3 = 8 buckets.

Talk about it

Should the answer be more than 4 or less than 4? How do you know?

Home mission

Pour 3 cups of dry beans into a bowl. Find a 1/3-cup scoop. Guess first: more or fewer than 3 scoops? Then scoop and count. Does the count match 3 ÷ 1/3?

When they are stuck, ask

- How many of those fit into this? Say it in words first.
- Did you flip the second fraction?
- Is the divisor less than 1? Then which way should the answer go?

Try not to say

- Keep, Change — that is enough.
- Dividing always gives a smaller answer.
- Flip whichever fraction looks easier.